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Miners Also Tough In Baseball

Texas Western's Miners, undefeated in their first four games, are in the process of bringing some needed respect back to the school's baseball team.

In a pre-season evaluation the Miners were rated as a no-hit, no-pitch freshman-endowed team with little chance of beating anybody.

THE UNIVERSITY of Albuquerque is the first to disagree with this forecast. They left here with four losses in as many games with the Miners. Saturday they lost a double header to the Miners 5-1 and 5-4.

"Our pitching has fared exceptionally well," according to coach Andy Cohen, "but the Albuquerque team wasn't much of a test. We'll know more about our future in about another month."

The Miners pitching staff, primarily inexperienced freshman, has yielded only five earned runs in 30 innings. Six of the nine hurlers have a .000 earned run average.

FRESHMEN, Tom Jennings and Bill Sanders, the only Miner hurlers to hurl complete games, have given up a total of five hits without an earned run.

"Our pitching has to hold up," mentioned Cohen, "because we can't rely on team hitting to carry us in every game."

The Miners boast a .316 hitting percentage with the top six hitters over the .350 mark. Catcher Chuck Stout leads the squad with a .667 average followed by Charlie West .467, Larry Harrell .429 and Bufe Morrison .375.

Miners coaches Cohen and "Krush" Kruschwitz attributed the early spirit of the team to the winning atmosphere that the football and basketball teams have honored this year.